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VOL. 9 · ST. GEORGE NORTH EAST

The Rematch in St. George North East

Ron Redhead and Nimrod Ollivierre met for the second election running. In 2022 Mr. Redhead won by 1,087; in 2026 he won by 2,027, and the NNP failed to carry a single one of 23 polling divisions. The NNP lost 585 votes, and 230 fewer people voted at all.

BY GREG HOSTEN ST. GEORGE NORTH EAST, GRENADA

ST. GEORGE NORTH EAST, GRENADA— Rematches are rare in Grenadian politics, and they are revealing. In St. George North East, the NDC's Ron Redhead and the NNP's Nimrod Ollivierre faced each other in 2022 and again in 2026: the same two names, in the same seat, four years apart. Whatever changed, therefore, changed among the voters and in the campaigns, not on the ballot.

> **"A rematch measures what each side did in between. Here, the NNP lost a third of its vote."**
> GREG HOSTEN

In 2022 Mr. Redhead won by 3,220 votes to 2,133. On 5th November he won by 3,575 to 1,548, with 19 for the GSDP and 4 for the GRP, and his majority almost doubled, from 1,087 to 2,027.

A SEAT WITH A COMPLICATED HISTORY

St. George North East takes in Tempe, Mount Parnassus, Beaulieu, La Mode, Boca, New Hampshire, Vendomme and the St. Paul's area, and it has changed hands more than once. The NDC's Nazim Burke held it after 2008. The NNP's Tobias Clement won it in 2013 and 2018, then left the government benches to become Leader of the Opposition in the last Parliament, obliging the NNP to find a new caretaker.

That caretaker was Mr. Ollivierre, who lost in 2022 when the NDC took government. Mr. Redhead, a former youth senator and long-standing NDC member, won the seat and entered government. Four years later both men returned to the contest.

THE NNP FELL; THE NDC HELD

The NNP's vote fell by 585, from 2,133 to 1,548, while the NDC's rose by 355. The NNP's share of the two-party vote dropped from 39.8 per cent to 30.2 per cent, a fall of 9.6 points, close to the national swing of 10.3.

What stands out is the shape of the change. Mr. Redhead's share of the whole electorate barely moved, from 41.7 per cent of all registered voters to 41.5 per cent, whereas the NNP's fell from 27.6 per cent to 18.0 per cent. The NDC did not so much grow its base as keep it, while the NNP's support drained away.

FEWER VOTERS THAN FOUR YEARS AGO

St. George North East's register grew by 890 names between 2022 and 2026, yet 230 fewer ballots were cast. Turnout fell from 69.8 per cent to 59.9 per cent, a drop of 9.9 points, tied with St. George South for the largest fall in the country.

This year 3,457 registered voters did not vote, up from 2,337. With the NDC's vote stable and the total falling, most of the new non-voters were people who had supported the NNP or who would have been its natural supporters. A candidate whom voters had already seen lose once did not give them a fresh reason to turn out.

NOT ONE DIVISION

The NNP did not carry any of the 23 polling divisions. Its best results came in the smallest: 44.5 per cent at the Constantine Methodist School, and 40.3 per cent across two divisions at Vendomme, where it came within ten votes in one division, 74 to 64.

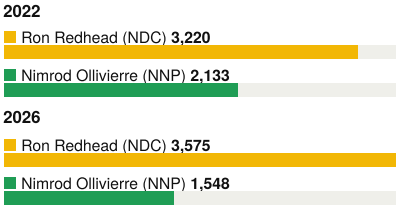
The large population centres went heavily to the NDC. At St. Mary's R.C. School in Tempe, with five divisions and more than 2,000 voters, the NNP took 31.0 per cent; at Mount Parnassus, 29.6 per cent; at St. Paul's, 26.9 per cent; and at La Mode, 26.5 per cent, including one division the NDC won by 172 votes to 32. At Boca Secondary School the NNP took 23.0 per cent.

WHAT A REMATCH TELLS YOU

A rematch is a natural experiment: when the

2022 VS 2026

Votes by candidate, in party colours



2,027 votes
NDC winning margin in 2026

BY THE NUMBERS

2,027
NDC winning margin, up from 1,087 in the 2022 rematch

0 of 23
Polling divisions won by the NNP

–9.9 pts
Fall in turnout, tied for the largest in the country

–585
Fall in the NNP vote since 2022

same two candidates meet again, the result measures what each side did in the interval. In St. George North East, Mr. Redhead held his share of the electorate, while the NNP lost about a third of its vote.

Running the same losing candidate again can succeed, as David Andrew demonstrated in St. Andrew South East, but only when the candidate spends the intervening years visibly working the seat. The numbers here show no such growth on the NNP's side.

ONE THOUSAND AND FOURTEEN VOTERS

To have won the seat, the NNP would have needed 1,014 voters to switch sides, or 2,028 more of its own supporters to turn out, almost three in five of those who stayed home. St. George North East is not a seat the NNP can expect to win in 2030 on a normal swing.

It is, however, a large seat of 8,617 voters that the NNP held as recently as 2018. Restoring the party's 2022 vote alone would cut the NDC's majority by more than a quarter and add hundreds of votes to the NNP's national total.

WHAT CAN BE DONE: A FOUR-YEAR PLAN FOR THE NORTH-EAST

St. George North East needs a reset more than a rerun.

Year one, 2027: decide the candidate early. If the party opts for a new face, name that person in 2027 and commit to two elections; if it keeps Mr. Ollivierre, give him a permanent office and a full-time organiser, and judge the effort by measurable growth each year. Open the office in Tempe, the largest polling site.

Year two, 2028: begin where the NNP is closest, at Vendomme and Constantine, and build into Beaulieu and New Hampshire. Run a listening programme with young families in Tempe and Mount Parnassus, small businesses along the main roads, and residents of La Mode and Boca, and publish what they say.

Year three, 2029: recruit a captain for each of the 23 divisions, with a turnout target in each. The register grew by 890, and very few of the new names voted, so new voters should be registered and contacted every month.

Year four, 2030: set targets the party can meet and report against: win the first polling division, restore the 2022 vote of 2,133, and lift the NNP's share of the two-party vote above 40 per cent. A seat that cannot be won in one cycle must still be moving in the right direction.

THE LESSON FOR EVERY NNP SEAT

Running the same candidate twice is a choice that must be earned. In St. Andrew South East the NDC's losing candidate returned stronger; in St. George North East the NNP's returned weaker, and the seat drifted further away.

Every NNP branch with a losing 2026 candidate should now ask a simple question: what will be different in four years? If the answer is not measurable growth in contacts, volunteers and votes, the rematch will end as this one did.

THE ARITHMETIC OF ST. GEORGE NORTH EAST

Measure	2022	2026	Change
NNP votes	2,133	1,548	−585
NDC votes	3,220	3,575	+355
NNP share of two-party vote	39.8%	30.2%	−9.6 pts
NNP two-party share nationally	48.0%	37.7%	−10.3 pts
Winning margin	NDC +1,087	NDC +2,027	
Registered voters	7,727	8,617	+890
Ballots cast	5,390	5,160	−230
Turnout	69.8%	59.9%	−9.9 pts
Registered voters who did not vote	2,337	3,457	+1,120
NNP votes as a share of all registered voters	27.6%	18.0%	−9.6 pts
Polling divisions won by the NNP		0 of 23	
Switchers the NNP needed to win		1,014	

Two-party figures exclude minor candidates (2022: GRP 15; 2026: GSDP 19, GRP 4). 2026 figures are provisional results from the Parliamentary Elections Office, all 23 polling divisions verified.

WHAT IT MEANS FOR 2030/31

1. A rematch must be earned with four years of visible work.
2. Judge a returning candidate by measurable growth each year.
3. Watch turnout: it fell almost ten points, tied for the largest drop.
4. Start at Vendomme and Constantine, where the NNP was closest.
5. Open a permanent office in Tempe, the largest polling site.
6. Register and contact the 890 new names on the roll.
7. Captain all 23 divisions and win the first one.
8. Restore the 2022 vote of 2,133 as the first milestone.

Sources: Parliamentary Elections Office live results, live.elections.gd (2026, provisional; polling divisions read 9 Nov 2026); Wikipedia (2022 and 2008 general elections); NOW Grenada (new caretakers required for St. George North East, Jan 2021; NDC 2022 candidates; 2026 results); NDC (2022 candidate launch). Analytics computed by the author from the published counts. Analysis by Greg Hosten, Vol. 9 of a weekly constituency series. Written in the style of a newspaper report; not a publication of any news organisation.